

THE THRILL OF THE GAME

After Apple and Amazon, Netflix is looking to dip its toes into sports streaming, arguably the most lucrative segment in the OTT landscape. Recently, it had bid for the European streaming rights of the ATP tennis tour. Reportedly, it wants to scoop up the rights for niche sports like cycling and surfing and turn these into big-ticket attractions. But CEO Reed Hastings says that it won't join the usual bidding wars.

—SOHINI MITTER

SIDE EFFECT

India's second-largest pharma company, Aurobindo Pharma, is facing business reputation issues following the arrest of one of its Directors, P. Sarath Chandra Reddy, in the ongoing investigation into the Delhi liquor scam by the Enforcement Directorate. The company has said that Reddy's arrest is not connected to Aurobindo or its subsidiaries in any way. The company has also been in the news recently over the recall of its medical products in the US market last month.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA

SHOPPING FOR STORES

PHOTO BY CHANDRADEEP KUMAR



THE ARENA OF bids to acquire debt-laden Future Retail is seeing some interesting names. Apart from the Adani Group and Reliance Industries, names such as the DS Group, Dickey Alternative Investment Trust, Shalimar Corporation and Nalwa Steel and Power are also in the fray. In all, there are 16 bidders. Given that Reliance already owns a significant number of the Kishore Biyani-promoted Future Retail's stores (Big Bazaar being a prominent name), what remains of the company will be interesting to see.

For a process that has long been hanging fire, it will likely take some time before a winner emerges.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN

Setting Sail



THE WORLD'S LONGEST river cruise, covering a distance of nearly 4,000 km between Varanasi and Dibrugarh via Bangladesh, is set to be launched in the New Year. Called the Ganga Vilas, the cruise is expected to give a boost to the country's plans to develop inland waterways. The passage through Bangladesh has been made possible by the Indo-Bangladesh Protocol on Inland Water Transit and Trade.

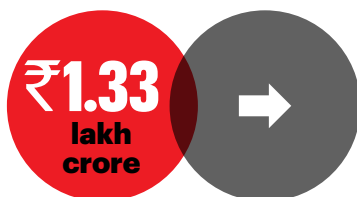
—MANISH PANT

MUTUALLY STRONG



The value of shares owned by mutual funds (MFs) has surpassed that of FDI in the month of October. Per data from NSDL, the total value of MF stock holdings was pegged at ₹22.8 lakh crore, marginally higher than FDI equity holdings of ₹22.7 lakh crore. MFs have seen record inflows, especially from SIPs, with October registering inflows of ₹13,041 crore—the first time that amount of retail money has come through the SIP route.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR



LIC'S TOTAL PREMIUM INCOME ROSE TO ₹1,32,631.72 CRORE IN THE SECOND QUARTER OF FY23 FROM ₹1,04,913.92 CRORE IN THE CORRESPONDING PERIOD A YEAR AGO